

and losing empathy. And when you label that stuff that used to be basic as “entitlement,” then you’re allowing yourself to be treated poorly. Is being able to buy food “entitlement”? Is having a place to sleep “entitlement”? Is seeing a doctor when you’re sick “entitlement”? Aren’t we all entitled to these things? Why do we need to EARN our humanity in a country founded on the idea that we have an inalienable right to life, liberty, and the pursuit of happiness? By shrugging off these requests as “entitlement,” you’re suggesting we don’t have a right to life-sustaining resources. And anyone who asks for more is punished (or weeded out of the system by being unhirable or fired).

Knowing my political stance, one of my Twitter followers tweeted me an Airbnb ad that said “renting out a room in their house paid for their wedding.” And I retweeted it with the cheeky caption, “normalization.” The replies to the ad were brutal. “Sell your privacy off so you can afford a basic human rite of passage!” Instead of congratulating these people on allowing strangers to shit in their bathroom so they can ingeniously bring in enough extra income to marry, maybe ask why their day jobs don’t afford them enough of a salary to do so or why wedding costs are jacked up so damn much. (Because they can price-gouge you for the fairy tale we’re being sold, baby. It’s all here in this book!)



In a *Jacobin* article, “Isn’t America Already Kind of Socialist?” Chris Maisano cites a “widely noted [Princeton University] 2014 study by two political scientists that says the political dominance of the wealthy is so pronounced that average citizens exercise ‘near zero’ influence over government policymaking.” (Thanks to Citizens United for the loosened campaign finance regulations.) What kind of power can we even have? #Resist, right? But I feel so overwhelmed and helpless.

Here comes my Charlie-Pepe Silvia moment: In 2008, the housing crisis hit. People our age started to realize shit was fucked up. So quickly, the baby boomer/media narrative became that millennials are “entitled.” Getting involved in activism and socialism is “naive.” Anyone who didn’t agree with the status quo was mocked. Activism trails off. Around the 2016 election, it picks up